

# Saber Khani

---

## Contact Information

410 McGuinn Hall  
Department of Sociology  
140 Commonwealth Avenue  
Chestnut Hill, MA 02467

☎ : (309) 531-5953  
✉ : [khanis@bc.edu](mailto:khanis@bc.edu)  
🔍 : [Google Scholar](#)  
👤 : [saberkhani.com](http://saberkhani.com)

## Research Interests

Collective Behavior and Social Movements, Political Sociology, Global and Transnational Sociology, Computational Social Science, Quantitative Methods, Global Middle East and North Africa (MENA).

## Education

|                                             |                                          |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Ph.D. in Sociology<br><i>Boston College</i> | Sep 2019 - Jun 2026 (exp)<br>Boston, USA |
| M.Sc Sociology<br><i>Boston College</i>     | Sep 2019 - May 2021<br>Boston, USA       |
| B.S. Sociology<br><i>Tehran University</i>  | June 2016<br>Tehran, Iran                |

## Publications Peer-reviewed journal articles

Vogelsang, Eric, Sara Moorman, Alan Mijares, Zackary Zanolli, Reza Tayari Ash-tiani, and **Saber Khani**. 2025. “Older Adult Social Participation and Cognition: Illustrating Survey and Measurement Heterogeneity Across Studies.” *Research on Aging*.

**Khani, Saber** and Sara Moorman. 2025. “Beyond the Classroom: How High School Extracurricular Activities Shape Cognitive Health in Later Life.” *The Journals of Gerontology: Series B*.

Moorman, Sara and **Saber Khani**. 2024. “High School Curriculum and Cognitive Function in the Eighth Decade of Life.” *Alzheimer Disease & Associated Disorders* 38(3):235-240.

**Khani, Saber** and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. “Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019).” *Comparative Political Studies* 57(10):1668-1702.

## Manuscripts Under Review

**Khani, Saber**. “Drilling and Dissent: Oil, Corruption, and Contention - Evidence From a Dual-Level Analysis, 2005–2019.” *Social Forces*. Under review.

**Khani, Saber**. “Smelling the Source: Oil Pollution, Sulfur Dioxide, and Targeted Protest in a Global grid cell Analysis, 2019–2024.” *World Development*. Under review.

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                  |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
|                               | <p><b>Khani, Saber</b> and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. “Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes.” <i>American Journal of Sociology</i>. Under review.</p> <p>Kadivar, Mohammad Ali and <b>Saber Khani</b>. “The Politics of War Commemoration in Iran.” <i>American Journal of Sociology</i>. Under review.</p> <p>Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, <b>Saber Khani</b>, Danial Vahabli, Vahid Abedini, and Samira Barzin. “The Contingency of Structures: Triggers and the Social Geography of Revolutionary Episodes in Iran 2018 - 2022.” <i>American Journal of Sociology</i>. Under review.</p> <p>* graduate student co-authors<br/> Ferati, Jalal*, <b>Saber Khani</b>, and Akash Chopra*. “From Presence to Prominence: Institutional Pathways and Women’s Appointments to Cabinets Across Regimes.” <i>Perspectives on Politics</i>. Revise &amp; Resubmit.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                  |
| <b>Working Papers</b>         | <p>Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, <b>Saber Khani</b>. “Uneven Incorporation: Ethnic Inequality Across Social Domains in Iran.” Manuscript ready for submission.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                  |
| <b>Original Datasets</b>      | <p><b>Saber Khani</b> and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. “<a href="#">Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds: State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization Evidence from Iran (2015-2019)</a>.” <i>Harvard Dataverse, V1</i>.</p> <p>Mohammad Ali Kadivar and <b>Saber Khani</b>. “Islamic Republic Martyrs Dataset (IRMD) (1980-1988).” N = 214,000+ individuals.</p> <p><b>Saber Khani</b>. “Petroprotest: Oil-Related Unarmed Protests Across 160 Countries (2005-2019).” N = 8000+ events.</p> <p><i>Survey</i><br/> <b>Saber Khani</b>. “Iraq National Survey (Feb–May 2025).” N = 750+ respondents across all 18 governorates.<br/> A comprehensive survey examines Iraqi citizens’ protest participation since 2015, perceptions of oil sector corruption and governance, and attitudes toward environmental impacts and economic policies.<br/> <b>Saber Khani</b>. “Basra City Survey (Mar–Apr 2025).” N = 500 participants from Basra city neighborhoods.<br/> This focused survey covers the same national topics while adding Basra-specific questions about proximity to oil infrastructure, local impacts of petroleum facilities on daily life, and comparative regional perspectives.</p> |                  |
| <b>Other Writings</b>         | <p>Mohammad Ali Kadivar, Peyman Jafari, Mehdi Hoseini, and <b>Saber Khani</b>. 2021. “<a href="#">Labor Organizing on the Rise Among Iranian Oil Workers</a>.” <i>Middle East Report Online</i>.</p> <p>Mohammad Ali Kadivar, <b>Saber Khani</b>, and Abolfazl Sotoudeh. 2019. “<a href="#">Iran’s Protests Are Not Just About Gas Prices</a>.” <i>Foreign Affairs</i>.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                  |
| <b>Fellowships and Awards</b> | <p>Young Scholars in Social Movements Mini-Conference (\$800)<br/> <i>University of Notre Dame</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <p>Fall 2024</p> |

|                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                        |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
|                                 | Donald White Teaching Excellence Award (\$700)<br><i>Boston College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Spring 2024            |
|                                 | Ivan Brown Research Grant (\$2,500)<br><i>Boston College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Spring 2023            |
|                                 | Graduate Fellow at Clough Center for Democracy (\$5,000)<br><i>Boston College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Fall 2022              |
|                                 | John B. Williamson Award (\$500)<br><i>Boston College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Fall 2019              |
|                                 | Sociology Department Summer Research Fellowship (\$5,000) Summer 2020 & 2021<br><i>Boston College</i>                                                                                                                                                                                       |                        |
| <b>Conference Presentations</b> | “Drilling and Dissent: Mapping Oil Governance, Corruption, and Contention as a Strategic Action Field”<br><i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>                                                                                                                            | Aug 2025, Chicago      |
|                                 | “Campus Co-opted: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes”<br><i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>                                                                                                                                             | Aug 2025, Chicago      |
|                                 | “Compliance on Campus: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocracies”<br><i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>                                                                                                                                                 | Sep 2024, Philadelphia |
|                                 | “Performative Representation: Gender, Regime Type, and Ministerial Appointments”<br><i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>                                                                                                                                                    | Sep 2024, Philadelphia |
|                                 | “Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)”<br><i>American Sociological Association (ASA)</i>                                                        | Aug 2023, Philadelphia |
|                                 | “Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)”<br><i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>                                                | Aug 2023, Philadelphia |
|                                 | “The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019”<br><i>TextXD</i>                                                                                                                                                                           | Dec 2022, California   |
|                                 | “The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019”<br><i>Social Science History Association (SSHA)</i>                                                                                                                                        | Nov 2022, Chicago      |
| <b>Research Experience</b>      | <b>Research Assistant</b><br><i>Older Adult Social Participation, Gender, and Cognitive Decline Project</i><br>PI: Dr. Eric M. Vogelsang, California State University, San Bernardino<br>Funded by National Institutes of Health (NIH) Support for Research Excellence (SuRE) Program (R16) | Fall 2023              |
| <b>Languages</b>                | <i>Coding:</i> R, Python, Stata, ArcGIS, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                        |
|                                 | <i>Languages:</i> Farsi (Native), English (Advanced), Arabic (Intermediate), Turkish (Beginner)                                                                                                                                                                                             |                        |

## Teaching Experience

### Boston College

#### *Instructor*

Introduction to Sociology

Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2024

Student Evaluations: 4.6/5.0 (N = 113)

- Created and taught an engaging and comprehensive course focused on foundational sociological concepts. This course not only gave students a strong foundation in key theories and principles, but also guided them in applying sociological analysis to critically examine contemporary real-world issues in the US and global societies.

Introduction to Statistics

Summer 2025

Student Evaluations: 3.8/5.0 (N = 4)

- Developed and delivered an intensive 6-week online asynchronous course that immersed students in fundamental statistical concepts. This course emphasized hands-on learning and equipped students with proficiency in Stata statistical software, helping them to manipulate, analyze, and visualize data effectively. Through engaging content and practical exercises, participants gained a deeper understanding of statistical methodologies and their real-world applications.

#### *Teaching Assistant*

Introduction to Statistics

Fall 2019, Fall 2021, Spring 2021

Introductory Sociology for Healthcare Professions

Spring 2020

## Academic Service

### Referee

*American Journal of Sociology*

*Comparative Political Studies*

*Conflict Management and Peace Science*

*ILR Review*

*Digest of Middle East Studies*

## References

Mohammad Ali Kadivar

Department of Sociology

Boston College

kadivarm@bc.edu

Wen Fan

Department of Sociology

Boston College

wen.fan@bc.edu

Yi Ming

Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences

Boston College

yi.ming@bc.edu

Paasha Mahdavi

Department of Political Science

University of California, Santa Barbara

paasha@polsci.ucsb.edu

Sara Moorman

Department of Sociology

Boston College

sara.moorman@bc.edu

Gerald M. Easter

Department of Political Science

Boston College

gerald.easter@bc.edu